

NIKE DIGITAL INSIGHTS 2025

YouTube Shorts & TikTok — Business Analytics Report

ANALYTICS BY

Ranjeet Anada

Data Analyst | Portfolio Business Analytics Project

Scope: 2025 TikTok & YouTube Shorts short-form video
performance dataset

Report date: 2025 Full-Year Analysis

Executive Summary

This portfolio analysis was conducted from the perspective of Nike's Global Digital Strategy Team to evaluate a 2025 TikTok and YouTube Shorts short-form video performance dataset, understanding where short-form content earns attention, engagement and completion across platforms, markets, creators and content formats. The dataset covers 48,079 videos and is analyzed as an external trend and performance dataset — it is not first-party Nike campaign data — and is used here as a proxy for how short-form content performs in the categories and markets relevant to Nike's audience.

TOTAL VIEWS	TOTAL VIDEOS	AVG ENGAGEMENT RATE	AVG COMPLETION RATE
4.77bn	48,079	7.54%	63.53%

Key Findings

- **TikTok leads on scale and engagement** in this dataset, capturing 60.3% of total views (2.88bn) at a 9.18% average engagement rate, versus YouTube's 39.7% view share (1.90bn) and 5.09% engagement rate.
- **Completion rate follows the same pattern:** TikTok videos complete at 67.60% on average versus 57.44% for YouTube Shorts.
- **Content categories are closely matched.** Views range narrowly from Pets (268M) to Science (252M) across the top nine categories, and completion-rate leaders (Tech, Sports, Pets, Beauty, Comedy) sit within a tight 63.1%–63.8% band.
- **#FYP dominates hashtag reach** with 1.18bn views, well ahead of #GRWM (169M), but median engagement rates across the top hashtags are all clustered near 7%, so reach and quality tell different stories.
- **Emoji-led titles correlate with higher engagement:** 78.99 median engagement per 1,000 views with an emoji in the title, versus 65.15 without.
- **Trend velocity and lifespan trade off directly.** Short trends peak fastest (12.5K median engagement velocity) but last only 5 days; Evergreen trends move slowest (1.5K) but persist 41 days.

Priority Recommendations

- Lead engagement-focused short-form testing on TikTok while keeping YouTube Shorts in the channel mix for reach diversification.
- Build a dual-speed content calendar that pairs fast-reactive trend content with evergreen, longer-life formats.
- Systematically test emoji-led titles and judge hashtags on engagement quality, not only on view totals.
- Prioritize distribution and traffic-source strategy (Following/ForYou-style discovery) over device-specific optimization, since device completion differences are minor.

Business Context, Data & Methodology

Project objective. Evaluate how short-form video content performs across platforms, markets, creators, content categories and publishing patterns during 2025, and translate the results into practical guidance for Nike's short-form digital marketing strategy.

Dataset. The source dataset (*youtube_shorts_tiktok_trends_2025.csv*) contains 48,079 TikTok and YouTube Shorts video records spanning platform, country, region, category, hashtag, creator, device, traffic source, trend type and engagement metrics. It is a trend-analysis dataset, not verified first-party Nike campaign data, and it contains no revenue, sales, spend, conversion or financial ROI fields.

Workflow. The dataset was loaded with a Python/Pandas import script, type-validated and loaded into a MySQL database (*nike_insights_2025.nike_videos*). Twelve SQL business-question queries were then run directly against MySQL to produce platform, category, creator, hashtag, timing, market, device, traffic, trend and seasonality summaries. The same MySQL source powers a five-page Power BI dashboard built with DAX measures for interactive exploration.



Data pipeline: CSV export → Python/Pandas validation → MySQL → SQL analysis → Power BI/DAX → business insights.

Data Quality Check

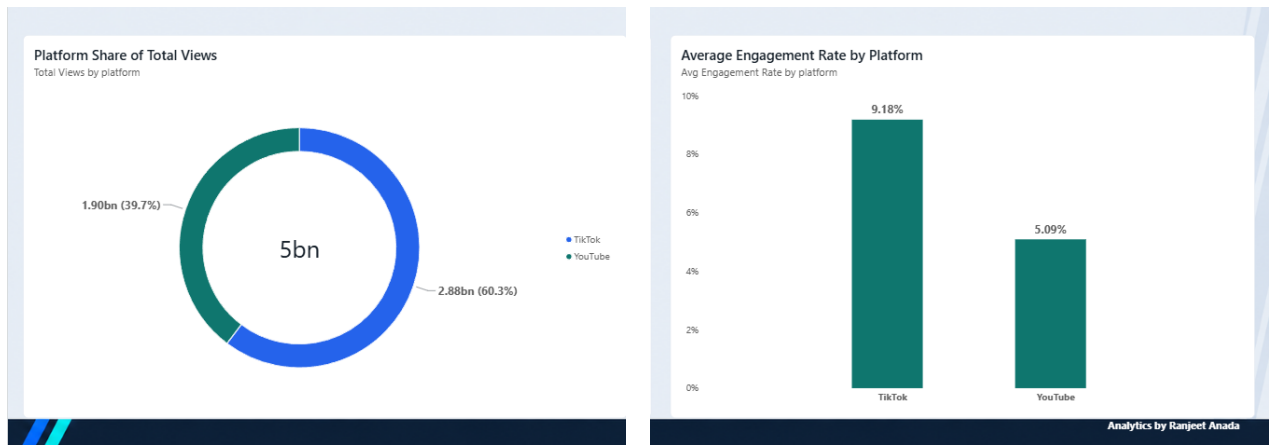
Every video record's *engagement_total* field was validated against the sum of its components (likes + comments + shares + saves) via a dedicated SQL query. The check returned zero mismatched rows across all 48,079 records, confirming the engagement totals used throughout this report are internally consistent.

Limitations

- This is a third-party trend dataset analyzed from Nike's strategic perspective, not verified first-party Nike campaign or paid-media data.
- "ROI" in this report refers strictly to content performance efficiency (views, engagement, completion, engagement per 1,000 views) and never to financial return, revenue or profit, none of which exist in the data.
- Findings describe patterns observed within this 2025 dataset and should be treated as directional testing hypotheses, not guarantees of future campaign performance.

Platform Performance: TikTok vs. YouTube

TikTok is the larger and more efficient platform in this dataset on every core metric measured: view share, engagement rate and completion rate. YouTube Shorts still represents a meaningful audience — nearly two in five views in the dataset — and remains relevant for reach diversification.



Source: Nike Digital Insights 2025 Power BI dashboard, Executive Overview page.

Metric	TikTok	YouTube	Overall
Videos analyzed	28,844	19,235	48,079
Total views	2.88bn (60.30%)	1.90bn (39.70%)	4.77bn
Avg. engagement rate	9.18%	5.09%	7.54%
Avg. completion rate	67.60%	57.44%	63.53%

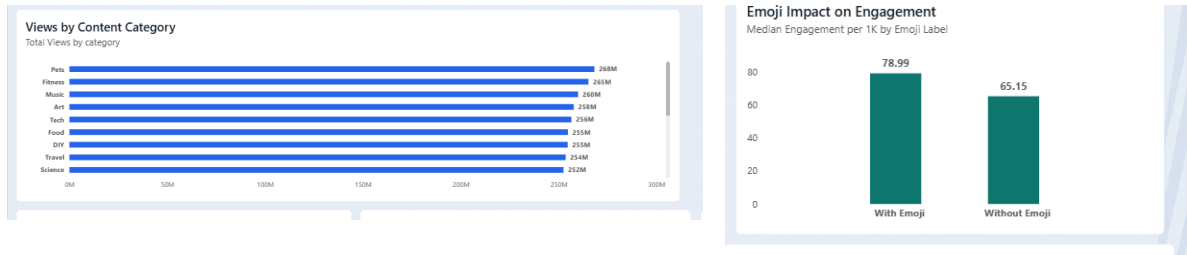
Business Takeaway

TikTok shows stronger engagement and view share in this dataset. This reflects the dataset's 2025 content mix and audience behavior; it does not guarantee that every future Nike campaign will outperform on TikTok, since paid media, creative execution and campaign objectives are not captured here.

Recommendation

Use TikTok-first testing for engagement-led short-form content, while maintaining a YouTube Shorts presence for platform diversification and audience reach beyond TikTok's user base.

Content category performance is closely bunched, hashtag reach is dominated by one tag while engagement quality is much more evenly spread, and titles that use emojis show a consistent engagement lift in this dataset.



Source: Nike Digital Insights 2025 Power BI dashboard, Content Insights page.

Top Content Categories by Total Views

Category	Total Views
Pets	268.2M
Fitness	265.2M
Music	259.9M
Art	257.7M
Tech	256.5M
Food	254.7M
DIY	254.6M
Travel	253.5M
Science	252.4M

Completion-rate leaders are Tech (63.84%), Sports (63.77%), Pets (63.73%), Beauty (63.71%) and Comedy (63.66%). The spread across the top five categories is under one percentage point, so category selection should not rest on completion rate alone.

Top Hashtags by Total Views

Hashtag	Total Views	Median Eng. Rate
#FYP	1,183.3M	7.15%
#GRWM	169.3M	6.98%
#Music	126.3M	7.03%
#Lifestyle	123.9M	7.30%
#Relatable	123.6M	7.23%
#Comedy	122.3M	7.32%
#Dance	120.3M	7.17%
#Cover	117.4M	7.02%

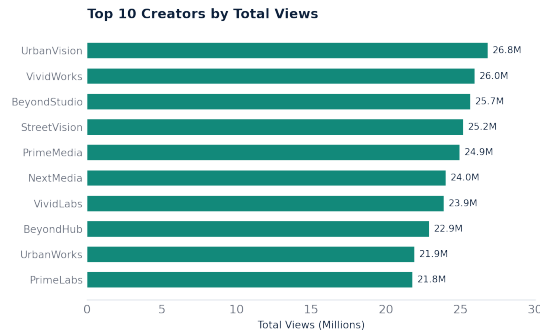
#FYP dominates reach at 1.18bn views — nearly seven times the next hashtag — but median engagement rate across the top hashtags sits in a narrow 6.98%–7.34% band, so reach alone should not be used as the sole quality signal.

Business Recommendations

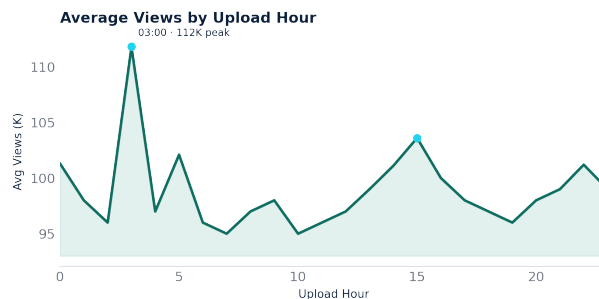
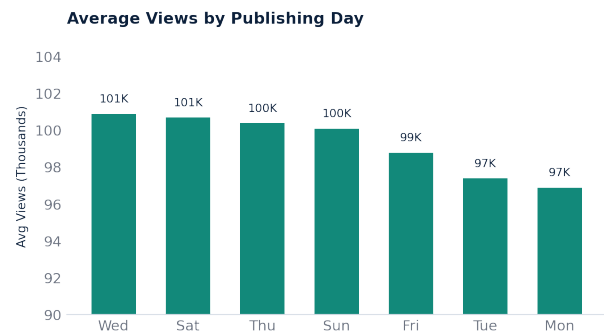
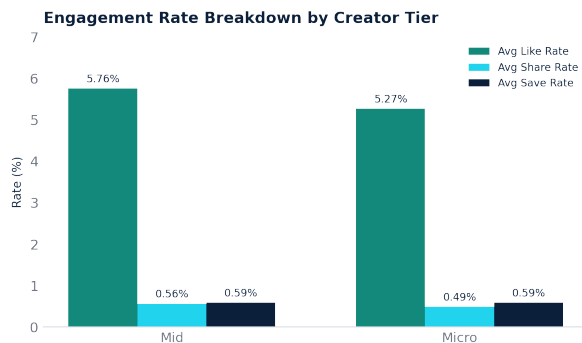
- Judge hashtags on both reach (total views) and engagement quality (median engagement rate), not reach alone.
- Systematically test emoji-led titles: the dataset shows a median engagement-per-1K lift from 65.15 to 78.99.
- Do not choose content categories solely from completion-rate differences of under one percentage point — pair category choice with audience-relevance and creative fit.

Two different creator rankings appear in this project and should not be mixed. The dashboard ranking shown below uses total views, while SQL Question 4 separately evaluates creators by average views per video; these metrics should not be interpreted as the same ranking.

Top 10 Creators by Total Views (Dashboard Ranking)



All ten of the top creators by total views fall in the Mid creator tier, led by UrbanVision (26.83M views), VividWorks (25.96M) and BeyondStudio (25.67M).



Average views peak sharply around 03:00 (~112K), with secondary strength around 15:00, 05:00, 00:00 and 22:00. Wednesday and Saturday lead publishing days at ~101K average views, though the day-of-week spread (97K–101K) is narrow.

Creator Tier Engagement

Mid-tier creators post modestly higher like rates (5.76% vs. 5.27%) and share rates (0.56% vs. 0.49%) than Micro-tier creators, while save rates are effectively equal (0.59% for both tiers).

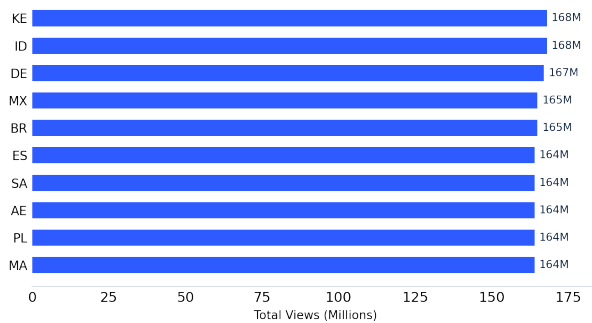
Recommendations

- Evaluate creators using total reach, average views per video, and engagement quality together — not any single dimension in isolation.
- Treat 03:00 and 15:00 as experimentation windows for publish timing, not guaranteed best-performing slots.
- Avoid rigid day-of-week posting rules; the observed gap between the strongest and weakest days is small.

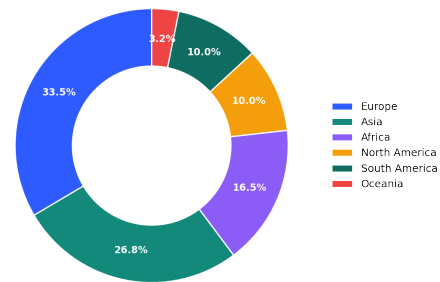
Market, Device & Traffic Insights

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Top 10 Countries by Total Views

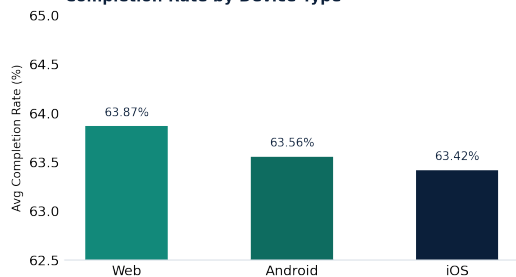


Regional Share of Total Views

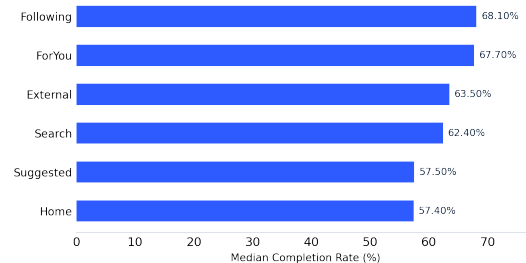


The top ten countries by total views (Kenya, Indonesia, Germany, Mexico, Brazil, Spain, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Poland, Morocco) are tightly clustered between 163M–168M views. At the regional level, Europe leads with 33.49% of total views, followed by Asia (26.76%), Africa (16.53%), North America (10.03%), South America (9.99%) and Oceania (3.20%).

Completion Rate by Device Type



Median Completion Rate by Traffic Source

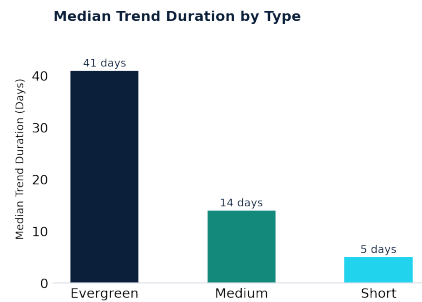
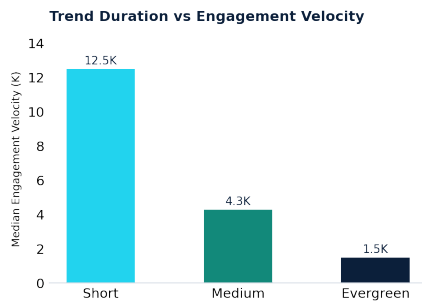


Device completion rates are close together (Web 63.87%, Android 63.56%, iOS 63.42%), a sub-one-point spread that does not support prioritizing one device platform over another. Traffic source shows a wider, more actionable spread: Following (68.10%) and ForYou (67.70%) discovery surfaces post the highest median completion, well ahead of Suggested (57.50%) and Home (57.40%).

Recommendations

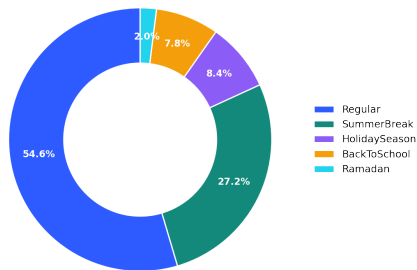
- Localize content for the strongest markets and regions, led by Europe and Asia by view share.
- Prioritize distribution and traffic-source strategy — particularly Following/ForYou-style discovery surfaces — over device-specific creative changes.
- Treat device differences as a low priority given the current completion-rate results (under one point apart).

Trend Momentum & Seasonality

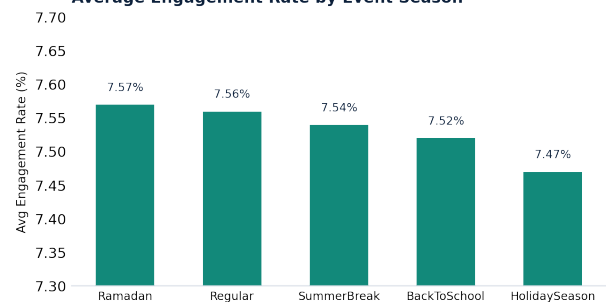


Trend speed and trend lifespan trade off directly. Short trends move fastest (12.5K median engagement velocity) but last only 5 days; Evergreen trends move slowest (1.5K) but remain relevant for 41 days — roughly eight times longer. Medium trends sit in between on both measures (4.3K velocity, 14 days).

Views Share by Event Season



Average Engagement Rate by Event Season



Regular (non-event) periods account for the majority of views (54.59%), followed by Summer Break (27.25%). Holiday Season, Back to School and Ramadan together make up the remaining 18.2% of views. Average engagement rate by season is very tightly clustered, from Ramadan's 7.57% high to Holiday Season's 7.47% low — a gap of only 0.10 percentage points, so no season stands out as a dramatic engagement winner.

Recommendation

Build a dual-speed content portfolio: fast-reactive trend content to capture short-lived momentum, paired with longer-life evergreen content that sustains visibility between trend cycles.

Strategic Recommendations

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The following recommendations are drawn directly from the platform, content, creator, market and trend evidence presented in this report. All measures are content-performance proxies (views, engagement, completion) — none represent financial ROI.

#	Recommendation	Evidence	Action	KPI
1	Lead with TikTok for engagement-focused testing	TikTok: 9.18% avg. engagement vs. 5.09% on YouTube	Shift a greater share of short-form testing budget to TikTok-first creative	Engagement rate, completion rate
2	Keep YouTube Shorts for reach diversification	YouTube retains 39.70% of total views (1.90bn)	Maintain a YouTube Shorts presence alongside TikTok-first testing	View share by platform
3	Build a dual-speed content portfolio	Short trends: 12.5K velocity / 5-day life; Evergreen: 1.5K / 41-day life	Pair fast-reactive trend content with evergreen content in the calendar	Engagement velocity, trend duration
4	Test emoji-led titles systematically	78.99 vs. 65.15 median engagement per 1K views	A/B test emoji-inclusive titles across upcoming content batches	Engagement per 1,000 views
5	Select hashtags on reach and engagement together	#FYP: 1.18bn views but engagement clustered ~7% across top tags	Pair high-reach tags with high-engagement niche tags in the same post	Total views, median engagement rate
6	Evaluate creators on multiple dimensions	Top-10 by total views differs from top-10 by average views (SQL Q4)	Score creators on total reach, average views and engagement quality together	Total views, avg. views, engagement rate
7	Localize content for strongest markets	Europe 33.49% and Asia 26.76% of total views	Prioritize market-specific creative adaptation for top-performing regions	Regional view share
8	Focus on discovery/traffic-source strategy	Following/ForYou completion 67.7%-68.1% vs. Home/Suggested 57.4%-57.5%	Optimize for algorithmic discovery placement over device-specific tweaks	Median completion rate by traffic source
9	Use top timing windows as test windows, not fixed rules	03:00 upload hour averages ~112K views; day-of-week spread is narrow	Trial priority windows (03:00, 15:00) without abandoning a broader posting cadence	Avg. views by hour/day

30-60-90 Day Action Plan & Conclusion

0–30 Days	31–60 Days	61–90 Days
• Launch TikTok-first creative testing for highest-view categories (Pets, Fitness, Music). • Start emoji-led title A/B tests across new uploads. • Trial publishing at 03:00 and 15:00 upload windows.	• Expand evergreen content production alongside short trend content. • Pair high-reach hashtags with high-engagement niche tags. • Begin market-specific creative localization for Europe and Asia.	• Review creator roster using total reach, average views and engagement quality. • Formalize a discovery/traffic-source optimization playbook. • Consolidate findings into a repeatable quarterly testing cadence.

Conclusion

This analysis of 48,079 short-form videos shows a consistent, evidence-backed picture: TikTok currently outperforms YouTube Shorts on reach and engagement, content category and device choices matter less than distribution strategy and creative execution, and the strongest opportunity lies in balancing fast-moving trend content with longer-life evergreen formats. None of these findings should be read as guaranteed campaign outcomes — they are directional signals from a single trend dataset, intended to sharpen where Nike's Global Digital Strategy Team tests next.

Executive Takeaways

- TikTok leads on scale and quality; keep YouTube Shorts for reach diversification.
- Distribution and discovery-surface strategy matter more than device-level optimization.
- Balance short, fast-moving trend content with longer-life evergreen content.
- Test emoji-led titles and multi-dimensional creator evaluation as near-term, low-cost improvements.
- Treat all findings as directional testing hypotheses drawn from a single 2025 trend dataset.